Example 4.6 In Fig.4.21, QA and PB are perpendiculars to AB. If $AO = 10$ cm, $BO = 6$ cm and $PB = 9$ cm. Find AQ.

Solution In ΔAOQ and ΔBOP, $\angle OAQ = \angle OBP = 90°$

$\angle AOQ = \angle BOP$ (Vertically opposite angles)

Therefore, by AA Criterion of similarity,

$\Delta AOQ \sim \Delta BOP$

$$\frac{AO}{BO} = \frac{OQ}{OP} = \frac{AQ}{BP}$$

$$\frac{10}{6} = \frac{AQ}{9} \Rightarrow AQ = \frac{10 \times 9}{6} = 15 \text{ cm}$$

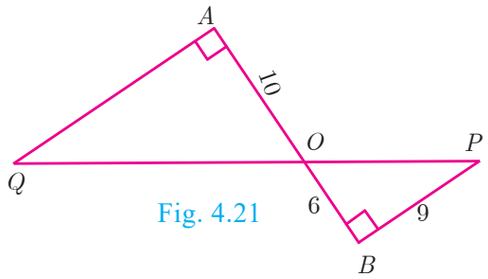


Fig. 4.21

Example 4.7 The perimeters of two similar triangles ABC and PQR are respectively 36 cm and 24 cm. If $PQ = 10$ cm, find AB.

Solution The ratio of the corresponding sides of similar triangles is same as the ratio of their perimeters.

Since $\Delta ABC \sim \Delta PQR$,

$$\frac{AB}{PQ} = \frac{BC}{QR} = \frac{AC}{PR} = \frac{36}{24}$$

$$\frac{AB}{PQ} = \frac{36}{24} \Rightarrow \frac{AB}{10} = \frac{36}{24}$$

$$AB = \frac{36 \times 10}{24} = 15 \text{ cm}$$

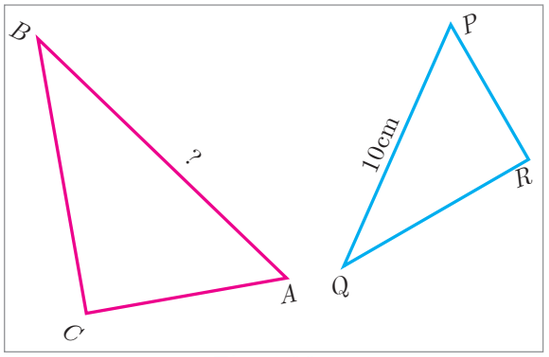


Fig. 4.22

Example 4.8 If ΔABC is similar to ΔDEF such that $BC = 3$ cm, $EF = 4$ cm and area of $\Delta ABC = 54$ cm^2. Find the area of ΔDEF.

Solution Since the ratio of area of two similar triangles is equal to the ratio of the squares of any two corresponding sides, we have

$$\frac{\text{Area}(\Delta ABC)}{\text{Area}(\Delta DEF)} = \frac{BC^2}{EF^2} \Rightarrow \frac{54}{\text{Area}(\Delta DEF)} = \frac{3^2}{4^2}$$

$$\text{Area}(\Delta DEF) = \frac{16 \times 54}{9} = 96 \text{ cm}^2$$

Example 4.9 Two poles of height 'a' metres and 'b' metres are 'p' metres apart. Prove that the height of the point of intersection of the lines joining the top of each pole to the foot of the opposite pole is given by $\frac{ab}{a+b}$ metres.

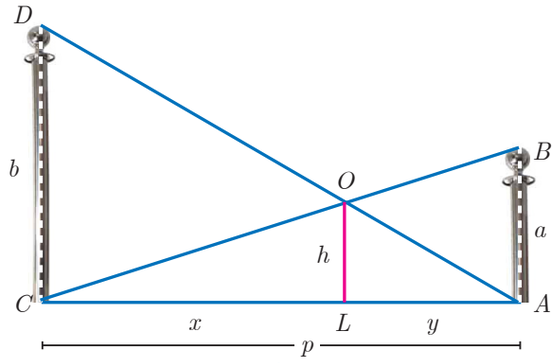


Fig. 4.23

Solution Let AB and CD be two poles of height 'a' metres and 'b' metres respectively such that the poles are 'p' metres apart. That is $AC = p$ metres. Suppose the lines AD and BC meet at O, such that $OL = h$ metres

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